AL MIRATH

East Africa Infrastructure & SEZ Development Tracker 2023

Source-dated infrastructure, special economic zone and corridor intelligence through 2023

Corporate Expansion & Real Estate Opportunity Intelligence

Prepared from the Al Mirath infrastructure dataset | Reporting cut-off: 31 December 2023

Important: project value, expected jobs, corridor classification, standardized status and expected completion fields include dashboard modelling/enrichment. They are not externally verified disclosures unless explicitly supported by the source record.

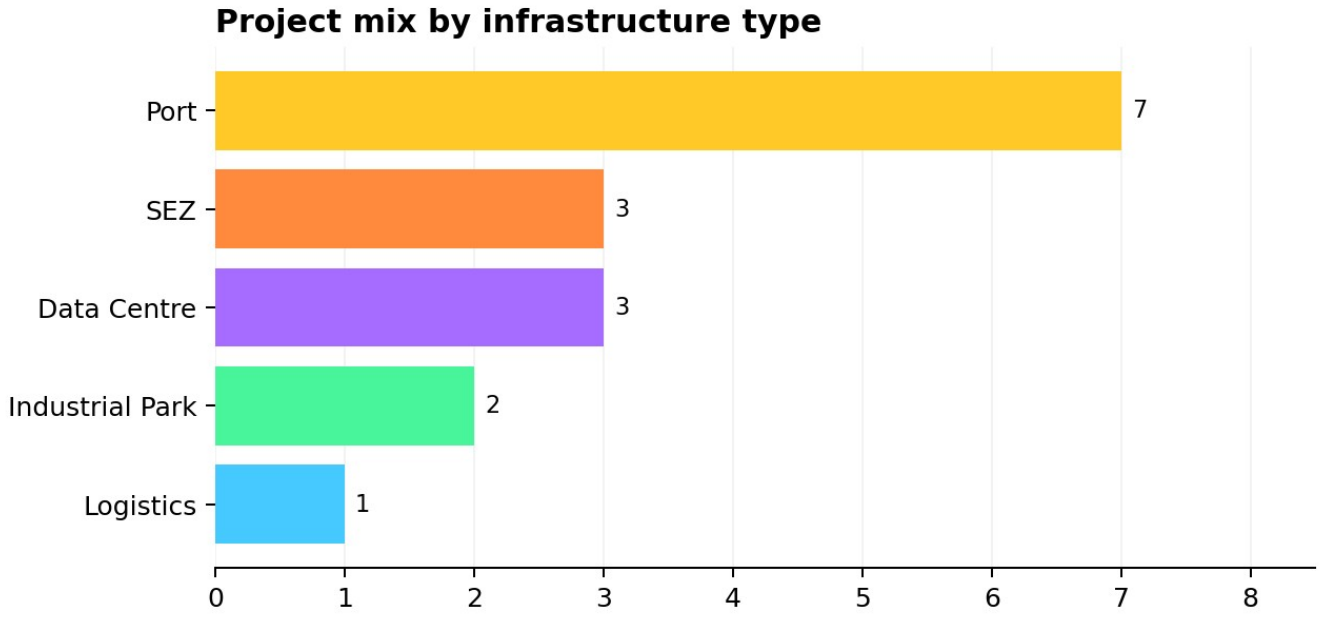
Executive Summary

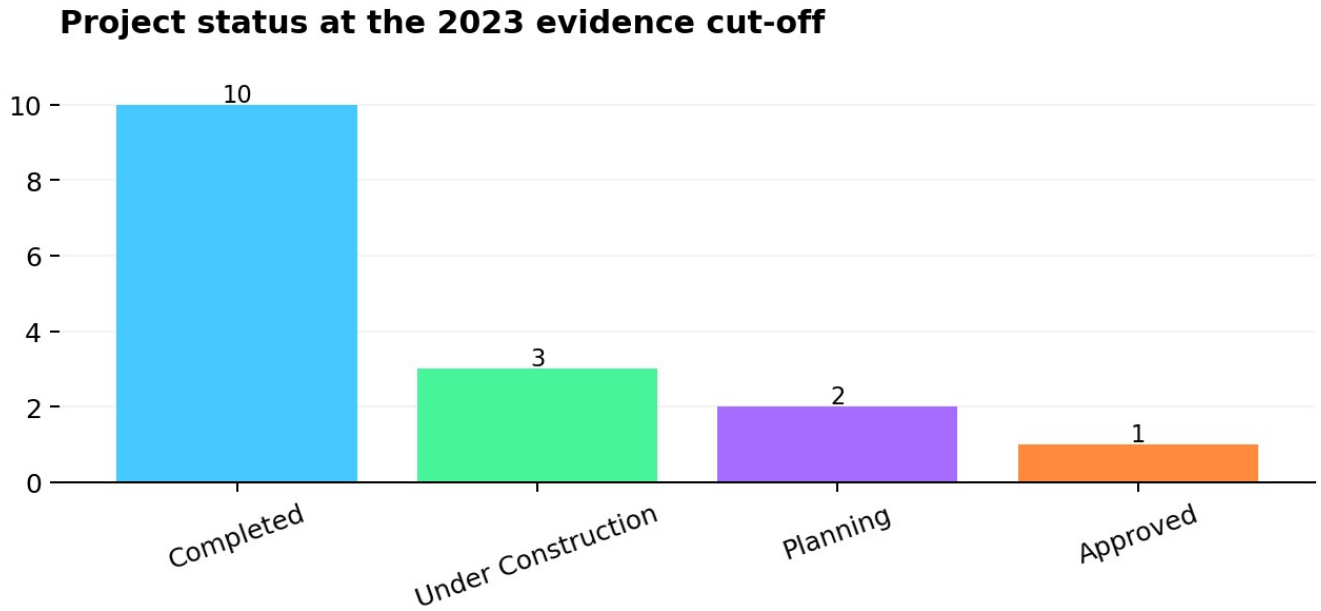
16	11	3	$19.2B
Projects reviewed	**Countries**	**SEZs**	**Modelled value**
source date <=2023	markets represented	SEZ Flag = Yes	dashboard field

- The 2023 evidence cut-off contains 16 infrastructure records across 11 East African markets, spanning ports, special economic zones, industrial parks, data centres and logistics infrastructure.
- Transport-related assets dominate the evidence set: 8 of 16 records are classified as transport infrastructure, including major port and inland-container assets.
- Three records are flagged as SEZs: Djibouti International Free Trade Zone, Kigali Special Economic Zone and Berbera Economic Zone.
- At the cut-off, the standardized dashboard status classifies 10 projects as completed, 3 as under construction, 2 in planning and 1 approved. These labels should be read as dashboard classifications, not independent status verification.
- The strongest infrastructure-to-real-estate link is industrial/logistics enablement: port access, inland dry ports, SEZs, rail, data centres and industrial parks can improve location attractiveness for warehouses, factories, distribution centres and digital infrastructure.

Interpretation: the tracker is a development-intelligence tool. An infrastructure record does not by itself establish investable land, tenant demand, transaction pricing or guaranteed completion.

1. Infrastructure Portfolio Composition





Ports are the largest single project type in the 2023-cut evidence set, followed by special economic zones and data centres. This creates a strong trade-and-connectivity bias in the development pipeline rather than a conventional roads-and-utilities inventory.

Completed projects dominate the standardized status field, but under-construction and planning records remain strategically important because they can change future industrial and logistics accessibility.

2. Special Economic Zone Focus

3	$7.9B	19,850	2
SEZ records	**Modelled SEZ value**	**Expected jobs**	**Corridors**
through 2023	dashboard field	modelled field	strategic links

Djibouti International Free Trade Zone (DIFTZ): Djibouti | Djibouti City, Djibouti | Completed | Source date 08 Jan 2021

- Operator / Developer: Djibouti Ports & Free Zones Authority / Great Horn Investment Holding, with China Merchants Group. Corridor: Horn of Africa Corridor. Source basis: China Merchants signs deal for 3bn expansion of Djibouti City port.

Kigali Special Economic Zone (KSEZ): Rwanda | Kigali (Gasabo district), Rwanda | Completed | Source date 09 Mar 2023

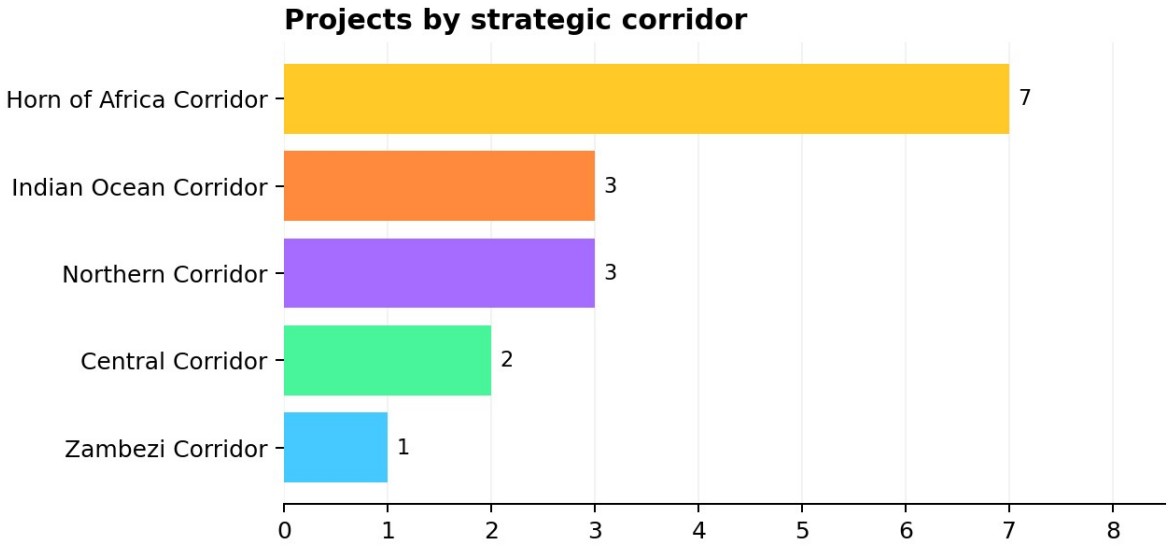
- Operator / Developer: Rwanda Development Board (RDB). Corridor: Northern Corridor. Source basis: Rwanda: Kigali Special Economic Zone to Be Doubled in Size.

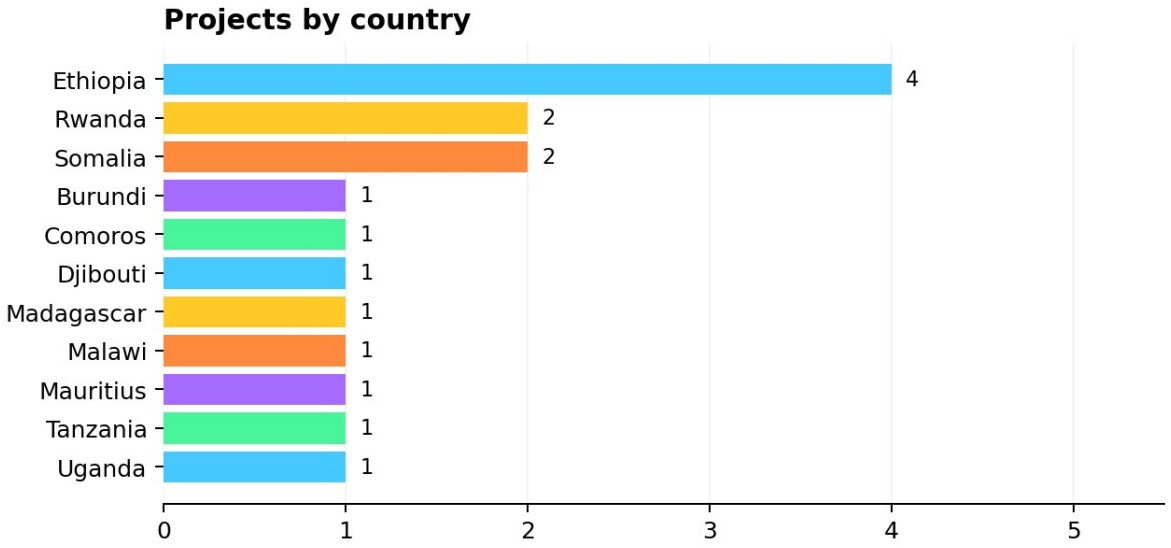
Berbera Economic Zone (BEZ): Somalia | Berbera, Somaliland | Completed | Source date 03 Mar 2023

- Operator / Developer: DP World and Government of Somaliland. Corridor: Horn of Africa Corridor. Source basis: DP World and Somaliland Government open Berbera Economic Zone.

SEZ investment and expected-jobs values are dashboard model fields in this workbook. The original source columns remain authoritative for project name, location, operator/developer, narrative status, source title, source URL and source date.

3. Regional Corridors & Location Intelligence





The Horn of Africa Corridor has the largest project concentration in the 2023-cut tracker, driven by Djibouti and Ethiopia assets plus Berbera/Bosaso-related infrastructure. The Northern Corridor is represented by Rwanda and Uganda logistics/digital infrastructure, while the Central Corridor includes Burundi and Tanzania port development.

- Horn of Africa: free-zone, rail, dry-port, port and data-centre infrastructure links Ethiopia/Djibouti with the wider Red Sea/Gulf trade interface.
- Northern Corridor: Kigali logistics/SEZ assets and Uganda digital infrastructure support regional distribution.
- Central Corridor: Bujumbura and Dar es Salaam port development strengthen inland-market connectivity.
- Indian Ocean Corridor: Comoros, Madagascar and Mauritius combine port and industrial development themes.

4. 2023 Infrastructure & SEZ Project Tracker

The table below lists all infrastructure records in the uploaded tracker with a source date on or before 31 December 2023. Status is the workbook standardized-status field; users should consult the original narrative and source URL before relying on current project status.

Country	Project	Type	Status	Source date	Corridor
Burundi	Port of Bujumbura Modernization (Lake Tanganyika Transport Corridor Development Project, Phase I)	Port	Under Construction	2023-08-25	Central Corridor
Comoros	Port of Moroni Deep-Water Port Redevelopment	Port	Approved	2022-06-10	Indian Ocean Corridor
Djibouti	Djibouti International Free Trade Zone (DIFTZ)	SEZ	Completed	2021-01-08	Horn of Africa Corridor
Ethiopia	Addis Ababa-Djibouti Railway	Logistics	Completed	2018-01-01	Horn of Africa Corridor
Ethiopia	Hawassa Industrial Park	Industrial Park	Completed	2016-07-01	Horn of Africa Corridor
Ethiopia	Modjo Dry Port (Inland Container Depot)	Port	Under Construction	2021-06-01	Horn of Africa Corridor
Ethiopia	Raxio Ethiopia Data Centre (ET1)	Data Centre	Completed	2023-11-01	Horn of Africa Corridor
Madagascar	Toamasina Port Extension (Phase 2) and MICTSL Concession Extension	Port	Under Construction	2021-12-13	Indian Ocean Corridor

Part 1 of 2 - projects are ordered by country and project name.

4. 2023 Infrastructure & SEZ Project Tracker (continued)

Country	Project	Type	Status	Source date	Corridor
Malawi	Malawi National Data Centre	Data Centre	Completed	2022-07-28	Zambezi Corridor
Mauritius	Rose Belle Pharmaceutical and Life Sciences Park	Industrial Park	Planning	2021-03-26	Indian Ocean Corridor
Rwanda	Kigali Logistics Platform (Masaka Dry Port / Inland Container Depot)	Port	Completed	2019-10-21	Northern Corridor
Rwanda	Kigali Special Economic Zone (KSEZ)	SEZ	Completed	2023-03-09	Northern Corridor
Somalia	Berbera Economic Zone (BEZ)	SEZ	Completed	2023-03-03	Horn of Africa Corridor
Somalia	Bosaso Port Expansion	Port	Planning	2023-08-19	Horn of Africa Corridor
Tanzania	Port of Dar es Salaam (DP World concession)	Port	Completed	2023-10-22	Central Corridor
Uganda	Raxio Uganda Data Centre	Data Centre	Completed	2021-05-26	Northern Corridor

Source-date cut-off is used to avoid importing later project updates into a report labelled 2023.

5. Real Estate & Investment Implications

Industrial and logistics real estate

- Ports, dry ports, rail links and SEZs can reduce logistics friction and improve the attractiveness of industrial, warehouse and distribution locations. The key diligence question is whether land, utilities, customs access and last-mile road capacity are actually available at the specific site.

Digital infrastructure

- The 2023-cut set includes data-centre assets in Ethiopia, Malawi and Uganda, showing that infrastructure-led real estate demand is not limited to conventional warehousing. Power reliability, fibre connectivity, land security and cooling requirements become critical location variables.

SEZ-linked development

- DIFTZ, Kigali SEZ and Berbera Economic Zone illustrate different SEZ models, but the existence of an SEZ should not be treated as evidence of available space, market rents or guaranteed investor incentives. Plot availability and operating terms require separate verification.

Priority diligence before transaction decisions

- Verify current project status and commissioning dates directly with the project operator or public authority.
- Obtain verified land availability, title/lease terms, infrastructure connections, zoning and environmental approvals.
- Build observed market evidence for rents, vacancy, construction costs, cap rates and tenant demand around each infrastructure node.
- Test corridor relevance using actual freight flows, border performance, customs requirements and last-mile access rather than project announcements alone.

6. Methodology & Data Notes

- Reporting cut-off: 31 December 2023. This report includes Infrastructure records where Source Date is on or before the cut-off date.
- Source-aligned fields preserved from the workbook include Country, Project Name, Type, Location, Operator / Developer, Status, Scale / Capacity, Source Title, Source URL and Source Date.
- Dashboard modelling/enrichment fields include Project Value (USD M), standardized status where interpretation is required, expected completion year, expected jobs, corridor assignment and coordinates.
- Modelled project values are used only as dashboard scenario/enrichment fields and must not be presented as externally verified project disclosures.
- The tracker is infrastructure intelligence, not a property-listing database. Infrastructure proximity does not confirm land availability, occupancy, valuation or transaction readiness.

Source Evidence Register

Project	Country	Source title	Source date
Port of Bujumbura Modernization (Lake Tanganyika Transport Corridor Development Project, Phase I)	Burundi	Burundi: the Port of Bujumbura will soon be renovated and modernized thanks to funding from the African Development Bank Group and the European Union	2023-08-25
Port of Moroni Deep-Water Port Redevelopment	Comoros	Will Comoros Be China's Next "Djibouti" In Indian Ocean Region?	2022-06-10
Djibouti International Free Trade Zone (DIFTZ)	Djibouti	China Merchants signs deal for 3bn expansion of Djibouti City port	2021-01-08
Addis Ababa-Djibouti Railway	Ethiopia	Addis Ababa-Djibouti Railway	2018-01-01
Hawassa Industrial Park	Ethiopia	Hawassa Industrial Park	2016-07-01
Modjo Dry Port (Inland Container Depot)	Ethiopia	Chinese firm launches 110-mln-USD expansion project of Ethiopian dry port	2021-06-01
Raxio Ethiopia Data Centre (ET1)	Ethiopia	Raxio launches data center in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	2023-11-01
Toamasina Port Extension (Phase 2) and MICTSL Concession Extension	Madagascar	ICTSI Madagascar terminal concession extended until 2040	2021-12-13
Malawi National Data Centre	Malawi	Malawi launches national data center	2022-07-28
Rose Belle Pharmaceutical and Life Sciences Park	Mauritius	Un parc pharmaceutique à Rose Belle	2021-03-26
Kigali Logistics Platform (Masaka Dry Port / Inland Container Depot)	Rwanda	Rwanda closer to becoming a regional logistics hub with the launch of Kigali Logistics Platform	2019-10-21
Kigali Special Economic Zone (KSEZ)	Rwanda	Rwanda: Kigali Special Economic Zone to Be Doubled in Size	2023-03-09
Berbera Economic Zone (BEZ)	Somalia	DP World and Somaliland Government open Berbera Economic Zone	2023-03-03
Bosaso Port Expansion	Somalia	DP World's 366M Bosaso port expansion in Somalia nears completion, minister reveals	2023-08-19
Port of Dar es Salaam (DP World concession)	Tanzania	DP World Signs 30-Year Concession to Operate Multi-Purpose Dar es Salaam Port in Tanzania	2023-10-22
Raxio Uganda Data Centre	Uganda	Raxio opens Tier III data center in Uganda	2021-05-26

Prepared for Al Mirath Real Estate Advisors | East Africa Infrastructure & SEZ Development Tracker 2023